

Member of the Grande École Network in France
Now Offering:



Industry-Aligned Specializations

Globally Recognized

Part-time Programs for Professionals

100% Online Format

SMS / Call to Register – Admissions Open

+971 50 211 9833



31543733_51

Hamdan promoted to Lieutenant General

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Supreme Commander of the UAE Armed Forces, has issued a federal decree promoting Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence, to the rank of Lieutenant General.

Shaikh Hamdan's promotion comes one year after his appointment to two of the nation's top Cabinet positions, Minister of Defence and Deputy Prime Minister, on July 14, 2024. He was officially sworn in before Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed four days later, on Union Pledge Day.

Pivotal role

Over the past 12 months, Shaikh Hamdan has played a pivotal role at the heart of federal government, guiding defence strategies, strengthening international partnerships, and supporting the UAE's long-term security and development objectives.

Since his appointment as Crown Prince of Dubai on February 1, 2008, by decree from His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, Shaikh Hamdan has consistently demonstrated a forward-looking approach grounded in innovation, resilience, and national pride.

DXB marks busiest first half on record with 46m flyers

NEW TECH TO ENSURE PASSENGERS DON'T HAVE TO REMOVE LIQUIDS, LAPTOPS

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

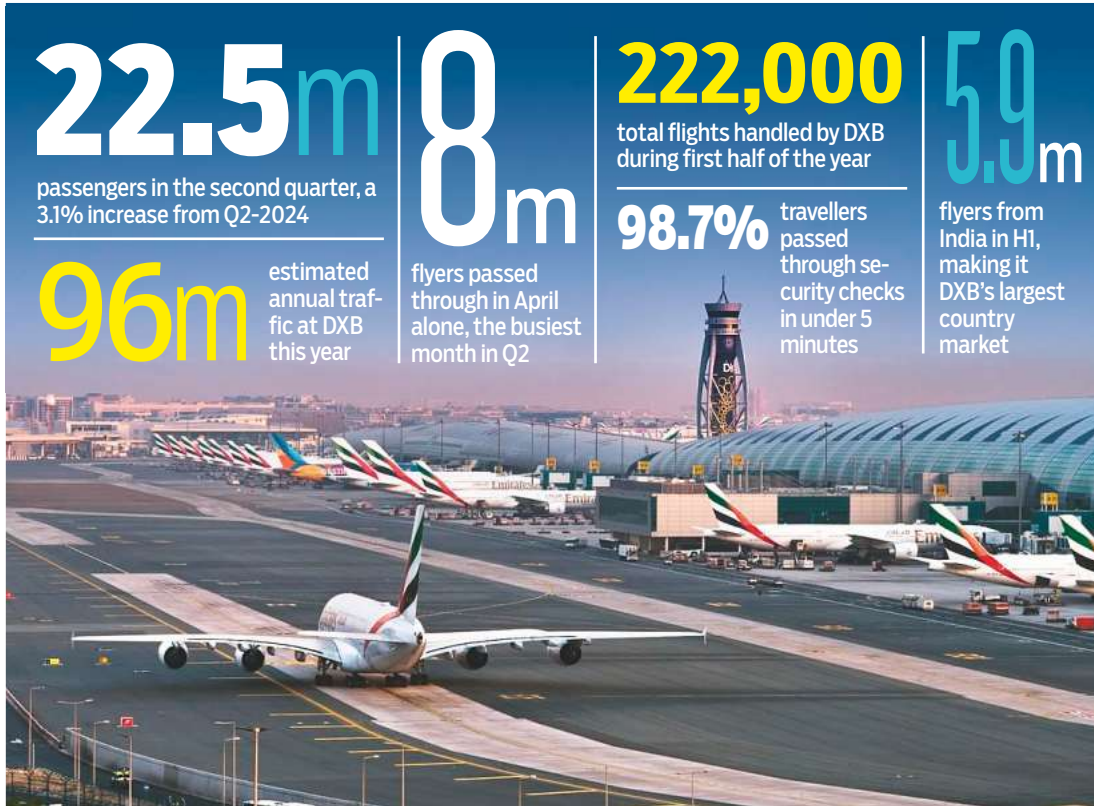
Dubai International (DXB) welcomed 46 million passengers in the first six months of 2025, marking its busiest first half on record.

The 2.3 per cent year-on-year growth underscores DXB's resilience, the continued strength of Dubai's aviation sector and the airport's ability to maintain high performance despite temporary regional airspace disruptions in May and June. This achievement reinforces DXB's vital role in connecting Dubai to the world and supporting the city's broader economic progress.

In the second quarter alone, DXB served 22.5 million travellers, an increase of 3.1 per cent over the same period last year. April emerged as the busiest month of the quarter and the most active April on record, with 8 million flyers passing through the terminals. Average monthly traffic in H1 stood at approximately 7.7 million, with daily volumes averaging 254,000. January was the busiest month of the period and also set a new monthly record, with 8.5 million flyers.

76% load factor

DXB handled 222,000 total flights during the first half of the year, while the load factor reached 76 per cent. A total of 41.8 million bags were processed, with 91 per cent delivered within 45 minutes on arrival. The mishandled baggage rate remained low at just 2 bags per 1,000 guests, significantly outperforming the



2024 industry average of 6.3 reported by SITA, the IT provider for the air transport industry.

India remained DXB's largest country market in H1 with 5.9 million passengers, followed by Saudi Arabia with 3.6 million, the United Kingdom with 3.0 million, Pakistan with 2.1 million, and the United States with 1.6 million travellers.

Efficiency at key passenger touchpoints also remained consistently high. In the first half, 99.2 per cent of flyers cleared departure passport control in under 10 minutes, 98.4 per cent cleared arrivals in under 15 minutes, and

98.7 per cent passed through security checks in under 5 minutes.

New security tech

DXB is also currently trialling new security technology that would allow passengers to pass through checkpoints without removing liquids, laptops, and other electronic devices from their bags.

According to Paul Griffiths, CEO of Dubai Airports, the new machinery, which includes advanced checked-in baggage and passenger baggage screening systems, is designed to allow liquids over 100ml and laptops to

remain in carry-on luggage. This move aligns with similar measures being implemented in European airports.

"We are already installing new machinery into both hold baggage screening and passenger baggage screening, which means that laptops and liquids can stay in bags," said the aviation veteran. "And I think that's just the first step. The next step is to use AI to profile some of the things that are in customer luggage, and that will make the security checkpoints even quicker," he added. — with inputs from WAM

SEE ALSO P5

NATION

Dh100,000 fine, jail for drivers who flee after causing accident | P2

FINANCE

Should you ask AI chatbots like ChatGPT to manage your salary? | P7

INDIA

Heavy rainfall in Delhi brings widespread waterlogging, traffic chaos | P11



Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE: UAE: Dh 5.00 | Bahrain: BD 0.500 | S.Arabia: SR 5.00
India: Rs 40.00 | Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Blurred lines: AI bands signal new era for music business

Producers of songs seeing a million plays tend to be unreachable

NEW YORK

A rising tide of artificial intelligence (AI) bands is ushering in a new era where work will be scarcer for musicians.

Whether it's Velvet Sundown's 1970s-style rock or country music projects 'Aven-this' and 'The Devil Inside', bands whose members are pure AI creations are seeing more than a million plays on streaming giant Spotify. No major streaming service clearly labels tracks that come entirely from AI, except France's Deezer.

Meanwhile, the producers of these songs tend to be unreachable. "There is going to be a lot of music released that we can't really tell who made it or how it was made," said music producer, composer and performer Leo Sidran.



The Oscar-winning artist sees the rise of AI music as perhaps a sign of how "generic and formulaic" genres have become. AI highlights the chasm between music people listen to "passively" while doing other things and "active" listening in which fans care about what artists convey, said producer and composer Yung Spielberg on the Imagine AI Live podcast.

Spielburg believes musicians will win out over AI with "active" listeners but will be under pressure when it comes to tunes people play in the background while cooking dinner or performing mundane tasks.

If listeners can't discern which tunes are AI-made, publishers and labels will likely opt for synthetic bands that don't earn royalties, Spielberg predicted.

— AFP

ENTERTAINMENT

Pamela ditches beach for big laughs in *The Naked Gun* reboot

Baywatch star plunges headlong into slapstick chaos | P15



THE BIGGEST HEALTHCARE AWARDS IN THE REGION

جوائز الصحة السنوية ANNUAL HEALTH AWARDS

October 2025 - Grand Hyatt Dubai

CELEBRATING
YOUR SUCCESS



الصحة
HEALTH
The most acclaimed HEALTH & LIFESTYLE magazine in the region

Nominate
now!!!



www.healthmagazine.ae

Last date of submission - September 20, 2025

**SUBSCRIBE NOW
FOR JUST Dh 100/-**

**AND RECEIVE BENEFITS
WORTH Dh 400!**

**BODY & SOUL HEALTH CLUB
ONE DAY PASS**

**SECOND OPINION CONSULTATION AT
THUMBAY UNIVERSITY HOSPITAL**



**GET EVERY ISSUE OF
HEALTH MAGAZINE
DELIVERED AT
YOUR DOORSTEP
FOR A YEAR**

**FOR MORE INFORMATION & SPONSORSHIP
CALL - 056 929 5053, 056 585 8618**